

THE BIG PICTURE

Borrowing Cost

Fear Index

Mid-Term Rates

Gold (Safety)

Cash Rate

WHERE THE SMART MONEY IS GOING

REAL0.08

HEALT0.13

ENERG0.24

UTILI0.34

CONS.0.49

FINAN0.93

CONS.2.15

COMM.2.25

INDUS2.36

TECHN7.58

MATER58.29

1

AMZN

BUY

\$261.31

-0.51%

8/10

AWS growth reaccelerating on AI workloads while Alexa+ monetizes retai

2

MU

BUY

\$1011.75

+4.13%

8/10

Memory chip supercycle meets US-China tech decoupling — MU is the dome

3

NVDA

BUY

\$225.01

-0.07%

8/10

The picks-and-shovels play on the AI buildout — riding hyperscaler cap

Big options bets on MSFT (Technology) — 40.9x normal volume, P/C 0.79, largest: PUT \$515 (28.0x OI)

No unusual behind-the-scenes trading to flag

No Congress members buying or selling stocks this week

EARNINGS COMING UP	FED & ECONOMY TODAY	SHORTS GETTING SQUEEZED?
No major earnings this week	No major events today	No squeeze setups detected

ARE BIG INSTITUTIONS NERVOUS?

BUYING PROTECTION

Junk bonds: cautious · Safe bonds: normal · borrowing getting pricier (stress)

WHERE MONEY IS ROTATING

Big money is piling into the classic defensive and rate-sensitive playbook right now — Real Estate, Healthcare, Utilities, and Energy are all seeing unusually heavy bullish call buying, which tells me traders are positioning for the Fed to start cutting rates and are also betting Washington's next moves will favor these groups (think drug pricing deals getting finalized, energy permitting reform, and infrastructure/data-center power demand keeping utilities bid).

On the flip side, they're quietly bailing on or hedging Technology and Materials in a big way — Materials in particular has an absurd 47x volume spike on puts, which screams tariff retaliation fears and a China demand scare, while Tech looks like people finally locking in gains ahead of potential AI antitrust action, export controls, or just plain "this thing ran too far" profit-taking.

The bearish bets on Comm Services and Staples plus widening credit spreads (HYG and LQD both loaded with puts) tell me the smart money thinks the consumer is weakening and corporate borrowing is about to get more expensive — that's usually a signal for a choppy, defensive market over the next 4-8 weeks where boring beats exciting.

The interesting contradiction: stocks broadly are near highs but the options tape looks like people preparing for a growth scare, so either the hedgers are wrong or the index is masking real damage happening underneath.

YOUR WATCHLIST — HOW WE FEEL ABOUT EACH

1.	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc.	6.91/100
SMCI is a direct beneficiary of the ongoing AI data center buildo			
2.	BAH	Booz Allen Hamilton Holding Co	6.91/100
Booz Allen is the leading pure-play federal AI/cyber services fir			
3.	PATH	UiPath, Inc.	6.61/100
UiPath is pivoting from pure RPA into agentic AI automation with			

DEEP DIVES — FULL REPORTS START ON PAGE 3

Pages 3–4	AMZN	— Amazon.com, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 5–6	MU	— Micron Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 7–8	NVDA	— NVIDIA Corporation	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 9–10	MRVL	— Marvell Technology, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 8/10
Pages 11–12	HOOD	— Robinhood Markets, Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 13–14	GOOGL	— Alphabet Inc.	Buy	Conviction 7/10
Pages 15–16	AAPL	— Apple Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 17–18	PLTR	— Palantir Technologies Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 19–20	SPCX	— Procure Space ETF	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 21–22	META	— Meta Platforms, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10
Pages 23–24	TSLA	— Tesla, Inc.	Hold	Conviction 6/10

Apple Inc.
AAPL NASDAQ

Hold \$305.59 ▼ 0.11% 12M Price Target \$320.00 52-Week Range \$223.78 – \$344.57 Market Cap \$4.46T

AAPL: China Chip Drama Meets Premium Valuation Wall

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock is basically flat (\$305.59, -0.11%) but the real story is the Trump administration pressuring Apple NOT to buy Chinese memory chips (YMTC specifically). This matters because Apple was reportedly close to using cheaper Chinese memory to protect margins — now they're stuck between a policy rock and a cost hard place.
- David Tepper (billionaire hedge fund guy) disclosed he's SHORT Apple. When a heavyweight like that bets against the stock at these levels, it validates what the options market is already showing — big money is buying downside protection (put/call ratio at 0.62 with unusual put activity at \$330 and \$335 strikes).

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what's really going on: Apple is caught in the crossfire of US-China tech decoupling, and the White House just tightened the screws. If Apple can't use YMTC memory, they'll pay more for Samsung or Micron chips, which squeezes gross margins (the money they keep after making the product) by an estimated 50-100 basis points — small on paper but meaningful when you're a \$4.4T company priced for perfection. Simply Wall St. is calling the stock 21% above fair value, and Tepper's short position suggests smart money agrees. The takeaway: this isn't a stock that's about to crash, but the risk/reward at \$305 with a 39x forward earnings multiple leaves little room for policy mistakes or an iPhone cycle disappointment.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

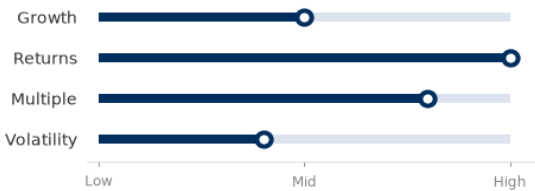
The big one is the administration's China chip pressure campaign — this is executive branch action, not legislation, so it can shift fast without Congress. Also watch the Section 301 tariff review on Chinese electronics: any expansion hits Apple directly since roughly 80% of iPhones are still assembled in China despite the India shift. Third rail: the DOJ antitrust case on the App Store is still grinding forward, and any adverse ruling could force Apple to open up its 30% "Apple tax" — that's a direct hit to Services revenue, which is the highest-margin part of the business and the reason bulls justify the premium multiple.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$305.59
12M Price Target	\$320.00
Upside / (Downside)	+4.7%
Market Cap	\$4.46T
FY2026E Revenue	\$425M
FY2027E Revenue	\$455M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.85
FY2027E EPS	\$8.60
Fwd P/E	38.9x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$320.00	\$308.00	\$290.00
6 Months	\$345.00	\$315.00	\$275.00
1 Year	\$375.00	\$320.00	\$260.00
2 Years	\$420.00	\$350.00	\$250.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$425.00	\$275.00
10 Years	\$750.00	\$550.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors (especially US-based memory like Micron and Sandisk) are benefiting directly from the China chip pressure — if Apple can't buy YMTC, someone else gets that order. Domestic manufacturing plays are also catching a bid as CHIPS Act money continues deploying.

COOLING OFF: China-exposed consumer tech and companies with high Chinese supply chain dependence. The market is starting to price a "US-China cold war premium" into any company that can't clearly explain its China exit strategy.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is quietly rotating from mega-cap tech into AI infrastructure names (chips, data centers, power) because that's where the government spending and capex is actually flowing. Apple is stuck in an awkward middle — too big to be a growth play, too consumer-exposed to be a pure AI beneficiary.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the Apple story but want more torque, look at the Services ecosystem plays — payment processors and streaming names that ride Apple's platform. Also, Micron (MU) is the direct beneficiary if Apple is forced to buy American memory.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still riding the AI capex wave — every hyperscaler is still spending, and export controls to China actually helped domestic pricing power.
- MU (Micron): Direct beneficiary of the "don't buy Chinese memory" policy — if Apple is forced away from YMTC, Micron gets the order flow.

AAPL CONTEXT: Apple is lagging the AI-native names badly this year — it's up but nothing like NVDA or the semi complex. That tells you the market views Apple as an AI consumer, not an AI producer, and it's not going to get the same multiple expansion. For Apple to catch up, they need to show Apple Intelligence is actually monetizable — otherwise it stays a "safe" mega-cap that trades sideways while the AI trade rages elsewhere.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio (core holding)

Entry Points: \$280-290 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: iPhone unit sales decline >8% YoY or China revenue drops >15%

Hedging: Buy protective puts at \$290 strike, or pair with a China-exposure short

Palantir Technologies Inc.

PLTR NYSE

Hold	\$172.55 ▼ 0.86%	12M Price Target \$185.00	52-Week Range \$106.37 – \$207.52	Market Cap \$414.65B
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PLTR: Pentagon AI Tailwind Intact, But Valuation Getting Stretched

WHAT HAPPENED

- PLTR is down about 0.9% pre-market, but the bigger story is the tone shift in the headlines. Barron's is running "The AI Trade Had 1 Sure Bet. Now Even That's Gone" — that's the market starting to question whether the AI leaders (PLTR being the poster child) can keep justifying these prices. When Barron's writes that headline, institutional PMs read it.
- Simply Wall St. is still calling PLTR ~9% undervalued on Pentagon AI momentum, and options flow is bullish (put/call 0.73, meaning way more people buying upside calls than downside protection). So the tape is mixed: momentum crowd still leaning in, valuation crowd getting nervous.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what today is really telling us: PLTR has become a sentiment barometer for the entire AI trade, which cuts both ways. The stock is sitting at 65% of its 52-week range with a \$415B market cap on roughly \$5B of revenue — that's investors paying about \$85 for every \$1 of sales, versus maybe \$15-20 for most software peers. The Pentagon AI narrative is real and the Trump administration's defense AI push (Golden Dome, autonomous systems, Replicator initiative) is a direct tailwind, but the stock is now priced as if every one of those contracts is already signed. What to watch: if the broader market starts rotating out of expensive AI names into cyclical or value, PLTR gets hit disproportionately because it has the least valuation cushion of any large-cap AI name.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

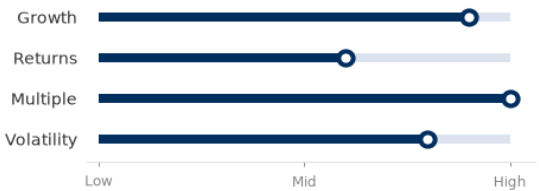
The FY2027 defense authorization is the big one — the House Armed Services Committee has been pushing to expand the software modernization budget (the pot of money PLTR's Maven and TITAN contracts get paid from), and the administration's push for AI-enabled command-and-control is essentially a Palantir job description. Also watch the OMB's ongoing effort to consolidate federal AI procurement onto a smaller list of approved vendors — PLTR is almost certainly on that list, which would be a moat (a barrier that keeps competitors out). Headwind risk: any Congressional appetite for defense spending cuts in a debt-ceiling fight would hit PLTR faster than diversified defense primes like LMT or RTX because Palantir is more concentrated in the "new spending" bucket rather than legacy programs.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$172.55
12M Price Target	\$185.00
Upside / (Downside)	+7.2%
Market Cap	\$414.65B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,850M
FY2027E Revenue	\$6,400M
FY2026E EPS	\$0.62
FY2027E EPS	\$0.85
Fwd P/E	278.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$190.00	\$175.00	\$155.00
6 Months	\$220.00	\$185.00	\$140.00
1 Year	\$250.00	\$195.00	\$125.00
2 Years	\$320.00	\$230.00	\$110.00
5 Years	\$500.00	\$300.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$800.00	\$450.00	\$70.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Defense tech and AI infrastructure — the administration's defense priorities (autonomous systems, missile defense, border tech) are direct tailwinds. Cybersecurity is also catching a bid on the back of federal mandates.

COOLING OFF: Legacy enterprise software (think older SaaS names) is losing share of wallet to AI-native platforms. Also watch for softness in consumer-facing tech as tariffs bite.

ROTATION WATCH: Money has been rotating from mega-cap AI (NVDA, MSFT) into second-derivative AI plays — power, cooling, defense AI. PLTR benefits from that rotation, which is partly why it's held up so well.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the government AI thesis but don't want to pay 85x sales, look at the defense primes with growing software businesses (LMT, RTX) or the pure-play defense tech names (AVAV, KTOS) that ride the same budget wave at cheaper multiples.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- ANET (Arista Networks): Winning on AI data center networking buildout — direct beneficiary of hyperscaler capex.
- AVAV (AeroVironment): Drone and autonomous systems demand exploding on the back of Ukraine lessons and DoD Replicator program.

PLTR CONTEXT: PLTR has been a leader in this cohort, but it's now the most expensive name in the group. When you're the most expensive stock in a hot sector, you outperform on the way up and underperform on the way down. The fact that it's lagging slightly today while the sector story is intact is a small yellow flag — could be early rotation out of the crowded trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 2-3% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$150-160 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Two consecutive quarters of decelerating government revenue growth, or a major DoD contract loss

Hedging: Pair with a short on a richly-valued smaller AI competitor, or buy protective puts 10-15% below spot

Amazon.com, Inc.
AMZN NASDAQ

Buy \$261.31 ▼ 0.51% 12M Price Target \$310.00 52-Week Range \$196.00 – \$287.20

Market Cap
\$2.82T

AMZN: Cooling Off After Run, But AI+Retail Story Intact

WHAT HAPPENED

- AMZN is drifting lower for the 5th session in a row — down from \$272 to \$261 (about 4% off the recent high). This isn't a "something broke" move; it's profit-taking after the stock ran to \$287 earlier this summer. The tell: options flow is still screaming bullish (put/call of 0.44 means traders are buying 2.3x more calls than puts) with massive call buying at \$237-\$247 strikes — smart money is positioning for a bounce, not a breakdown.
- Einride/Tesla Semi deal is quietly interesting — those trucks are going into Amazon's freight network. Small headline, but it signals Amazon is still aggressively electrifying logistics, which matters for margins long-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Bezos \$346M insider sale on Aug 3 near the \$286 top looks less like "the CEO knows something bad" and more like a pre-scheduled 10b5-1 sale (he's been selling in tranches all year to fund Blue Origin) — but it did cap the stock's momentum. Meanwhile, the Alexa+ shopping narrative is the sleeper catalyst nobody's pricing in: if Amazon can convert even 10% of Prime households to voice-driven purchases, that's a margin uplift because it cuts out ad-driven price comparison shopping. The bigger picture — AWS is the real story. Every dollar of enterprise AI spend increasingly flows through hyperscalers (AWS, Azure, GCP), and the recent yahoo piece framing "hyperscalers vs. memory chips" tells you where fund flows are heading. Watch for AWS growth acceleration in Q3 earnings — that's the number that either sends this to \$290+ or keeps it stuck at \$260.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two policy items to watch: (1) The FTC antitrust case against Amazon is still grinding through court — a 2026 ruling forcing divestiture of the logistics arm is the tail risk, but the current administration has signaled a lighter touch on Big Tech breakups, which is a quiet tailwind. (2) Tariffs on Chinese goods remain elevated under the current trade regime — this squeezes Amazon's 3P sellers (third-party marketplace merchants) who source from China, but Amazon actually benefits on the margin because it pushes sellers to use Amazon's own logistics and advertising to stay profitable. Also worth watching: the federal AI procurement push — AWS GovCloud is positioned to eat a huge share of any expanded government AI cloud spending.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$261.31
12M Price Target	\$310.00
Upside / (Downside)	+18.6%
Market Cap	\$2.82T
FY2026E Revenue	\$745M
FY2027E Revenue	\$825M
FY2026E EPS	\$7.20
FY2027E EPS	\$8.60
Fwd P/E	36.3x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$285.00	\$270.00	\$250.00
6 Months	\$310.00	\$285.00	\$240.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$310.00	\$230.00
2 Years	\$400.00	\$355.00	\$245.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$450.00	\$300.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$400.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: AI infrastructure (hyperscalers, memory chips, power/data centers) — enterprise AI budgets are still expanding and the administration's push for domestic AI leadership is a direct policy tailwind.

COOLING OFF: Traditional retail and consumer discretionary — tariff pass-through and cautious consumer spending are pressuring margins for pure-play retailers (Amazon straddles both worlds, which is why it's more resilient).

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from pure-AI plays (like NVDA) into "AI beneficiaries with real cash flow" — that's exactly where AMZN sits, which explains why the pullback has been shallow.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AMZN story but want more torque, look at data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power infrastructure names — AWS's growth directly feeds their revenue.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Azure keeps taking enterprise AI share and Copilot monetization is showing up in the numbers — cleanest AI story with the biggest moat.
- META (Meta Platforms): AI-driven ad targeting is printing money and Reels monetization keeps compounding.

AMZN CONTEXT: AMZN is lagging MSFT and META over the last month — the market is rewarding "pure AI winners with proven monetization" and treating AMZN like a mixed bag because of the retail exposure and antitrust overhang. That lag is actually the opportunity: if AWS growth surprises to the upside next quarter, AMZN closes the gap fast.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$255-262 on pullbacks; add aggressively sub-\$245

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: AWS growth decelerates below 15% or FTC breakup case gains real traction

Hedging: Small put spread or pair with short QQQ if tech gets frothy

Procure Space ETF

SPCX NASDAQ

Hold	\$146.23 ▲ 4.45%	12M Price Target \$155.00	52-Week Range \$104.83 – \$225.64	Market Cap \$1.93T
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SPCX: Space ETF Rips as NASA Spreads Contracts Around

WHAT HAPPENED

- SPCX is up 4.45% to \$146 — the catalyst is NASA handing Blue Origin and Firefly a fresh services contract, plus a \$1B Air Force contract floating around the sector. Translation: the government is actively spreading the wealth beyond just SpaceX, which is a huge deal for an ETF because it holds a basket of these smaller names (Rocket Lab, Planet Labs, Iridium, etc.), not just the 800lb gorilla.
- Sentiment tailwind from two IPO stories — Anthropic and SpaceX are being pitched as the largest 2026 IPOs, and prediction markets are eating it up. Even though SpaceX is private, the "space is investable again" narrative drags every space-adjacent name higher.

WHY IT MATTERS

The NASA contract news is actually the more important story than the SpaceX headlines — it signals the government is deliberately diversifying its space vendor base, which is exactly the thesis for owning an ETF instead of a single stock. If Blue Origin, Firefly, and Rocket Lab all start winning meaningful contracts, SPCX benefits more than a pure SpaceX bet would. But watch the options tape: put/call is 0.68 (bearish-leaning) AND there's a massive \$145 put buy for August expiry — someone big is hedging or betting this pop fades in the next two weeks. That tells me the smart money thinks this is a news pop, not a trend change yet.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big policy lever here is the FY2027 defense authorization and NASA appropriations — Congress is currently debating Space Force funding expansion and whether to boost the Commercial LEO Development program (the initiative replacing the ISS with private stations). If that funding sticks, it's a direct pipeline into SPCX holdings. The counter-risk: Barron's noted Trump has "abandoned his cheerleader role" for the market, and if the administration pivots toward budget austerity to offset tariff revenue shortfalls, discretionary space spending is an easy target. Also watch ITAR export rules — any loosening lets these companies sell satellites internationally, any tightening kills margins.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

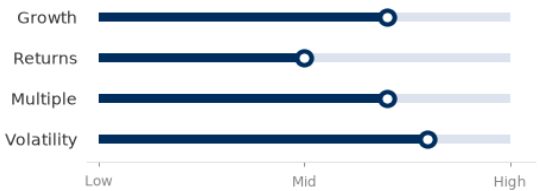
SPCX trades as a thematic basket, so forget traditional P/E — what matters is that its holdings collectively trade at roughly 6-8x forward revenue, meaning investors pay \$6-8 for every \$1 of sales these companies produce. That's expensive vs. the S&P at ~3x, but cheaper than pure AI plays at 15-20x. At \$146 the ETF is sitting at only 34% of its 52-week range (\$105-\$226), so it's closer to the lows than the highs — not a screaming bargain but not chasing froth either.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

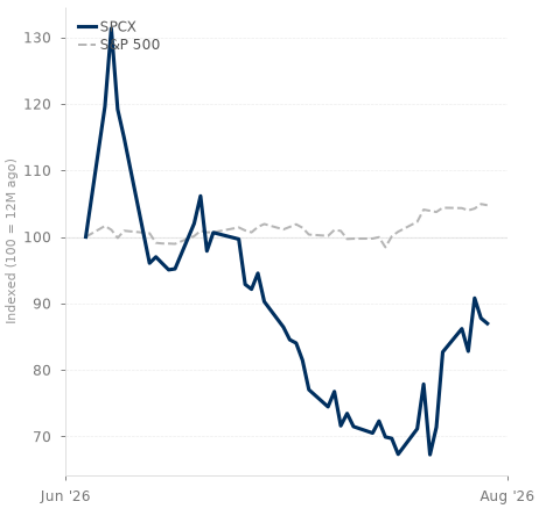
Key Data

Price (USD)	\$146.23
12M Price Target	\$155.00
Upside / (Downside)	+6.0%
Market Cap	\$1.93T
FY2026E Revenue	—
FY2027E Revenue	—
FY2026E EPS	N/M
FY2027E EPS	N/M
Fwd P/E	N/M

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$158.00	\$148.00	\$135.00
6 Months	\$175.00	\$155.00	\$125.00
1 Year	\$200.00	\$165.00	\$115.00
2 Years	\$240.00	\$180.00	\$100.00
5 Years	\$350.00	\$240.00	\$90.00
10 Years	\$600.00	\$380.00	\$80.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Space and defense — the NASA multi-vendor strategy plus that \$1B Air Force contract signals government dollars are flowing broadly, not just to primes like Lockheed and SpaceX.

COOLING OFF: Pure SpaceX-adjacent hype trades — the "319 million shares coming up for sale" story shows secondary market supply is increasing, which caps how frothy the private valuation can get.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from mega-cap tech into "picks and shovels" space/defense names as investors look for the next AI-adjacent theme. Orbital AI (satellite-based compute) is the buzzword to watch — that's what got the SpaceX price target hiked to \$248.

RELATED PLAY: If space keeps running, the ground-based infrastructure benefits too — think ground station operators, satellite component makers, and defense primes like LMT and RTX that supply the ecosystem.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- RKLB (Rocket Lab): Winning as the "second source" to SpaceX — every diversification contract from NASA/DoD lands in their lap.
- LHX (L3Harris): Defense-space hybrid benefiting from both budgets simultaneously.

SPCX CONTEXT: SPCX is participating in the rally but lagging pure-play names like RKLB because the ETF also holds slower-growing satellite operators. That's the tradeoff — you get less upside on rip days but also less downside on flush days. It's the "sleep at night" way to play space.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the sector setup but the bearish options flow and Trump's market disinterest keep me from pounding the table here.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio — this is thematic exposure, not a core holding. Space is volatile and binary on policy outcomes.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$135-140, which is where the ETF has found support recently. Chasing \$146 after a 4% pop is asking to get faded.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the real catalyst is the SpaceX IPO window and the FY2027 defense budget getting finalized.

WHEN TO BAIL: If NASA appropriations get cut meaningfully, if the SpaceX IPO gets pushed to 2027+, or if the ETF breaks below \$120 on volume.

HEDGING: Pair this with a broad defense ETF (ITA) so if space-specific news disappoints, the defense budget tailwind still works for you. Or just size small and use \$130 as your mental stop.

Robinhood Markets, Inc.

HOOD NASDAQ

Buy	\$96.25 ▲ 0.72%	12M Price Target \$115.00	52-Week Range \$63.52 – \$153.86	Market Cap \$86.54B
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HOOD: Crypto Summit at White House Fuels Optimism

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock up modest 0.72% but the real story is Trump meeting with crypto and prediction market execs — HOOD sits at the intersection of both (they own Bitstamp and have prediction markets via Kalshi partnership). This is the administration signaling more friendly regulation, which directly expands HOOD's addressable market.
- July DATs (daily average revenue trades — basically how many trades customers made per day) came in higher year-over-year per the Zacks note, confirming that user engagement isn't just holding, it's growing even after the huge run this stock has had.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to think about: the options market is flashing bearish (put/call at 0.70 with unusual put buying at \$98 and \$99 strikes) right as the stock trades near \$96 — that tells me big traders are hedging against a near-term pullback, possibly into September expiration. But that's tactical noise. The bigger picture is that a White House crypto meeting + tokenization progress at the SEC + a friendly Republican-led Congress = HOOD's crypto revenue line (which was ~35% of transaction revenue last cycle) has a structural tailwind that didn't exist 18 months ago. The stock is 36% of its 52-week range meaning it's already pulled back from \$153 highs — that's actually healthier setup than buying at the top.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Three policy threads matter right now: (1) The GENIUS Act and CLARITY Act — stablecoin and crypto market structure bills — either passing gives HOOD legal clarity to expand tokenized stocks and stablecoin products it's already piloting in Europe. (2) SEC tokenization framework is reportedly stalled per the Bloomberg/Motley Fool coverage, which is a near-term headwind because HOOD announced tokenized US equities for EU customers. (3) Prediction markets: CFTC's posture under this administration has been permissive, and if Trump's meeting produces even soft endorsement, HOOD's event contracts business (Super Bowl, elections, Fed decisions) becomes a real revenue line, not a novelty.

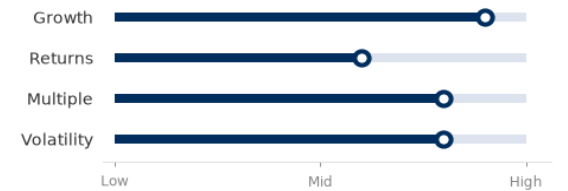
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At \$96 and roughly \$87B market cap, investors are paying about 21x forward revenue and ~50x forward earnings — that's expensive for a broker (Schwab trades at 15x earnings) but cheap for a fintech growing 30%+ with expanding margins. The justification only works if crypto stays hot AND tokenization actually rolls out AND they keep grabbing share from Schwab/Fidelity in younger demos. If any one of those legs wobbles, the multiple compresses fast — that's why the puts are being bought.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$96.25
12M Price Target	\$115.00
Upside / (Downside)	+19.5%
Market Cap	\$86.54B
FY2026E Revenue	\$4,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$5,100M
FY2026E EPS	\$1.85
FY2027E EPS	\$2.40
Fwd P/E	52.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



HOOD — Robinhood Markets, Inc. | August 18, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$108.00	\$98.00	\$85.00
6 Months	\$130.00	\$110.00	\$78.00
1 Year	\$160.00	\$115.00	\$70.00
2 Years	\$200.00	\$140.00	\$60.00
5 Years	\$300.00	\$180.00	\$45.00
10 Years	\$500.00	\$250.00	\$40.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Crypto-adjacent fintech (COIN, HOOD, Bitstamp-linked names) and prediction market plays — all riding regulatory thaw under Trump admin. Digital assets + tokenization = policy tailwind.

COOLING OFF: Traditional asset managers (T. Rowe, Franklin) losing mindshare to platforms that offer crypto + equities in one app; the Zacks piece on TROW using AI is defensive not offensive.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from legacy brokers into next-gen platforms — HOOD is the primary beneficiary but the trade is crowded, which is why puts are being bought here.

RELATED PLAY: If HOOD's tokenization story works, the picks-and-shovels play is the underlying infrastructure — Securitize (mentioned in CoinDesk as down 26% with 3x upside per one analyst) and Chainlink-adjacent names benefit from every tokenized asset issued.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- COIN (Coinbase): Direct beneficiary of the same White House meeting and market structure bills — often leads HOOD by a day or two on crypto policy news.
- IBKR (Interactive Brokers): Grinding higher on rate income and international expansion — the "boring" way to own the trading theme.

HOOD CONTEXT: HOOD is leading its peer group YTD but lagging its own 52-week high by ~37% — that gap closes if crypto legislation actually lands. It's the highest-beta way to play the retail trading + crypto policy trade.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — Bullish on the story but respectful of the bearish options flow signaling near-term downside; I'd rather buy the dip than chase here.

POSITION SIZE: 3-5% of portfolio — real upside but this stock can drop 20% in a week on crypto weakness, so size it like the volatile name it is.

ENTRY POINTS: \$88-92 on any macro-driven pullback; the \$98 put wall suggests we might get there in September.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst I'm waiting for is crypto market structure legislation (GENIUS/CLARITY Acts) passing, which unlocks the tokenization revenue story.

WHEN TO BAIL: If DATs decline for two consecutive quarters, or if Bitcoin breaks below \$80K signaling a real crypto bear market, I'm trimming aggressively.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge — buy a September \$90 put as insurance; costs a little but caps your downside if the bearish options flow is right about a pullback.

Meta Platforms, Inc.

META NASDAQ

Hold	\$568.97 ▼ 3.54%	12M Price Target \$620.00	52-Week Range \$520.26 – \$790.80	Market Cap \$1.45T
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META: Addiction Trial + Insider Selling = Overhang Building

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock down 3.5% and now sitting at just 18% of its 52-week range — brutal. The immediate catalyst is the social media addiction trial that kicks off Tuesday. This is the multi-state lawsuit alleging Meta designed Instagram to be addictive to kids, and it's the first one going to a jury — meaning we're about to get real headline risk instead of hypothetical legal risk.
- The COO dumped shares in a cluster on Aug 10 around \$600-605, and options traders are loading up on out-of-the-money puts (contracts that pay off if the stock falls) — 3-5x the normal volume at the \$650, \$680, \$690 strikes. That's smart money hedging or betting on more downside near-term.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to think about: the trial itself probably won't bankrupt Meta — they have \$70B+ in cash — but the discovery process leaks damaging internal documents, and that fuels the political case for stricter regulation. This matters because KOSA (the Kids Online Safety Act) has been hovering in Congress for two years, and a bad trial verdict or ugly headlines could be exactly the catalyst that pushes it through. If KOSA passes, Meta faces a "duty of care" standard for minors that would force major product changes to Instagram — the crown jewel. On the flip side, once the trial risk is priced in (and at \$569 vs a \$790 high, a lot of it is), any "not as bad as feared" outcome could snap the stock back hard. The setup right now is asymmetric risk into the trial, asymmetric reward once it's over.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things to watch: (1) KOSA revival — the Kids Online Safety Act keeps getting reintroduced, and this trial is fuel for it. If it passes, Meta eats compliance costs and possibly loses some engagement from teen users. (2) The FTC's ongoing antitrust case trying to force Meta to divest Instagram and WhatsApp is grinding through the courts — a loss there is existential, but a win (more likely) removes a massive overhang. Also worth noting: the Trump administration has been more industry-friendly on tech generally, but child safety is bipartisan — Meta doesn't get much political cover on this one.

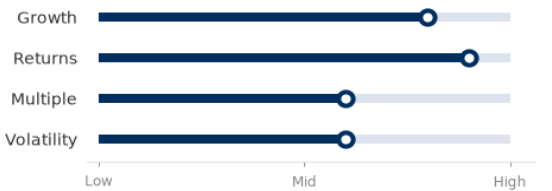
IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$569 and ~20-21x forward earnings (meaning you're paying \$20 for every \$1 of profit Meta's expected to earn next year), this is actually cheap for a company growing ad revenue in the mid-teens with 35%+ operating margins. Compare that to the S&P 500 at ~22x with much slower growth. The discount exists because the market is pricing in legal risk plus the massive AI capex spend (they're burning ~\$60B+ per year on data centers with unclear ROI). If the AI spend starts showing revenue attribution, this multiple expands fast.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$568.97
12M Price Target	\$620.00
Upside / (Downside)	+9.0%
Market Cap	\$1.45T
FY2026E Revenue	\$195M
FY2027E Revenue	\$220M
FY2026E EPS	\$27.50
FY2027E EPS	\$32.00
Fwd P/E	20.7x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$610.00	\$575.00	\$530.00
6 Months	\$680.00	\$620.00	\$500.00
1 Year	\$780.00	\$660.00	\$480.00
2 Years	\$900.00	\$720.00	\$450.00
5 Years	\$1200.00	\$850.00	\$400.00
10 Years	\$2000.00	\$1200.00	\$350.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: AI infrastructure (chips, data centers, power) is still the "one engine" the market is flying on — federal permitting reform on data centers is a direct tailwind. Defense tech is getting bid as US-Iran talks fade.

COOLING OFF: Consumer-facing social/ad platforms are under pressure from child safety litigation contagion. Anything reliant on teen engagement is in the crosshairs.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from mega-cap ad platforms (META, GOOGL) into pure AI infrastructure plays (NVDA, data center REITs) — investors want AI exposure without the regulatory baggage.

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AI capex story but hate Meta's legal risk, the picks-and-shovels play is data center REITs (DLR, EQIX) and power infrastructure (VST, CEG) — Meta is a customer of all of them.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the primary beneficiary of every AI capex dollar Meta and peers spend — Meta's spending is literally Nvidia's revenue.
- GOOGL (Alphabet): Similar ad-platform business but the antitrust ruling is largely behind them and YouTube isn't in the addiction crosshairs the way Instagram is.

META CONTEXT: META is LAGGING badly — 18% of its 52-week range while the Nasdaq is near highs. That underperformance tells you the market is specifically pricing Meta risk, not tech-sector risk. When a stock diverges from its sector this hard, either it's a value opportunity or the market sees something you don't. Right now, the trial says: market sees something.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — I like the business long-term but I don't like the setup this week. Cautiously optimistic, not pounding the table.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio. This isn't a starter position moment — legal overhangs deserve smaller sizing until they resolve.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add aggressively at \$540-555 if trial headlines drive a flush. Full position around \$500 if we get a really ugly week.

TIME HORIZON: 12-18 months. Waiting on: (1) trial resolution, (2) AI monetization signals in Q4/Q1 earnings, (3) FTC case ruling.

WHEN TO BAIL: Ad revenue growth drops below 10%, jury awards >\$10B in damages, or KOSA passes the Senate. Any of those = trim hard.

HEDGING: Simplest thing: buy a September put option (a contract that pays off if the stock falls below a set price) at the \$550 strike — costs you a small premium but caps your downside through the trial. Or just keep dry powder to average down.

Micron Technology, Inc.

MU NASDAQ

Buy	\$1011.75 ▲ 4.13%	12M Price Target \$1250.00	52-Week Range \$113.46 – \$1255.00	Market Cap \$1.14T
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MU: China Chip Ban Rumors + BofA \$1,550 Target Fuel Rally

WHAT HAPPENED

- MU popped 4% to \$1,011 — the driver is Bank of America hiking its price target to \$1,550 (call it ~53% upside from here), plus overnight reports that the Trump administration is pressuring Apple NOT to buy memory chips from Chinese suppliers. That's a direct handoff of market share to Micron and Samsung/SK Hynix — MU is the only US-based player, so politically it's the cleanest beneficiary.
- Counterweight: futures were weak this morning on rising Treasury yields (bonds paying more makes expensive tech stocks less attractive) and Middle East tensions flaring back up. So MU is fighting a macro headwind and still up 4% — that tells you the company-specific news is strong.

WHY IT MATTERS

The Apple/China chip story is bigger than one headline — it's the crystallization of a multi-year trend where the US government is effectively guaranteeing Micron a bigger slice of the global memory market by forcing Western customers off Chinese suppliers (YMTC and CXMT). If Apple actually complies, that's tens of billions in memory purchases getting redirected, and MU is one of only three credible suppliers globally. The BofA target hike to \$1,550 isn't random — analysts are baking in HBM (high-bandwidth memory, the chips that go into Nvidia AI GPUs) pricing staying tight through 2027 because AI demand is outrunning supply. Watch for: does Apple push back publicly? If they comply quietly, MU keeps running. If they resist and lobby against it, the political tailwind gets messier.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

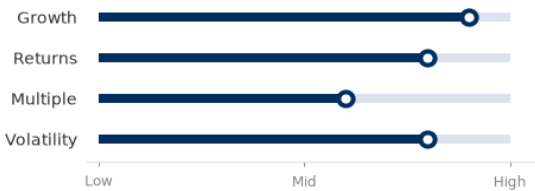
The CHIPS Act money is still flowing to Micron's Idaho and New York fabs — they're one of the largest grant recipients, and any expansion of CHIPS 2.0 funding (being discussed in Congress) is direct upside. The bigger near-term policy story is export controls: the Commerce Department is reportedly weighing tighter restrictions on Chinese memory makers, and the Apple pressure campaign suggests the administration is escalating from "restrict Chinese exports" to "restrict US companies from buying Chinese chips" — a much more aggressive stance that benefits MU disproportionately. Risk to watch: if a broader US-China trade deal gets negotiated (unlikely near-term given Middle East distraction), tech decoupling could soften.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$1011.75
12M Price Target	\$1250.00
Upside / (Downside)	+23.5%
Market Cap	\$1.14T
FY2026E Revenue	\$48,500M
FY2027E Revenue	\$62,000M
FY2026E EPS	\$14.20
FY2027E EPS	\$19.50
Fwd P/E	71.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$1150.00	\$1050.00	\$900.00
6 Months	\$1400.00	\$1250.00	\$850.00
1 Year	\$1600.00	\$1300.00	\$800.00
2 Years	\$1900.00	\$1500.00	\$750.00
5 Years	\$2500.00	\$1800.00	\$900.00
10 Years	\$4000.00	\$2500.00	\$1000.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors broadly, especially memory and AI infrastructure — every policy move from this administration seems to widen the moat for US-based chipmakers. Defense tech also catching a bid on Middle East tension.

COOLING OFF: Anything with China revenue exposure (Apple itself is caught in the crossfire), and rate-sensitive growth names as Treasury yields climb.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating INTO domestic semis and OUT of China-exposed consumer tech — the Apple headline is the perfect illustration of the trade. Rising yields are also pushing money out of speculative small-cap AI names into profitable mega-cap AI beneficiaries like MU and NVDA.

RELATED PLAY: If MU keeps running on HBM demand, watch the equipment makers — Applied Materials (AMAT) and Lam Research (LRCX) sell the picks and shovels to build the fabs. Also SanDisk if the memory trade broadens beyond DRAM into NAND.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- NVDA (Nvidia): Still the AI kingpin — every HBM chip MU sells basically goes into an Nvidia GPU, so they move together.
- AVGO (Broadcom): Custom AI silicon for hyperscalers keeps winning; policy tailwinds for US chip design are lifting all boats.

MU CONTEXT: MU is leading the memory subsector but lagging NVDA on a 1-year basis — which actually makes it the catch-up trade. The BofA upgrade suggests the Street is starting to see MU as the "next leg" of the AI trade rather than a cyclical laggard.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$950-980 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: HBM pricing crack, or Trump admin softens China chip stance in trade deal

Hedging: Buy protective puts around \$900, or pair with a short on a Chinese memory-exposed name

Tesla, Inc.
TSLA NASDAQ

Hold \$339.30 ▼ 0.87% 12M Price Target \$375.00 52-Week Range \$297.38 – \$498.83

Market Cap \$1.34T

TSLA: Cybercab Launch Imminent, Semi Orders Building

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock's down ~1% but the news is actually mixed-positive: Einride (Swedish trucking) just placed a Tesla Semi order big enough to move THEIR stock up 20% — that's a real validation signal for the Semi program, which has been vaporware-adjacent for years. The market shrugging suggests investors are already pricing in Semi success OR they're distracted by the bigger story.
- The bigger story: Cybercab (the steering-wheel-free robotaxi) is reportedly hitting Austin streets THIS MONTH, starting with employees. This is the whole bull thesis in a nutshell — if it works, TSLA is an AI company; if it doesn't, it's an overpriced carmaker.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what to think about: TSLA is trading at 21% of its 52-week range — meaning it's much closer to the yearly low (\$297) than the high (\$499). That's investors saying "show me" on robotaxis before they pay up again. The Cybercab Austin launch this month is a binary event — a clean rollout could re-rate the stock 20-30% higher because it validates the AI narrative; an accident or delay caves the multiple. Meanwhile, the options flow is telling: huge unusual call buying at \$340 strike (right at current price) suggests traders are positioning for a near-term pop, likely tied to the Cybercab news, while the put buying at \$425-450 looks like people hedging existing long positions rather than betting on collapse.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The elephant in the room: the federal EV tax credit (\$7,500 per vehicle) was killed under the current administration's tax package last year, and Tesla's auto margins have been compressing ever since — that's a structural headwind that isn't going away. On the flip side, the administration's push to loosen autonomous vehicle regulations (federal preemption of state-by-state AV rules) is a MASSIVE tailwind for Cybercab — Tesla can't scale robotaxis if every state has different rules, so watch the NHTSA's proposed AV framework expected this fall. Also on the radar: tariffs on Chinese battery components remain elevated, which hurts Tesla's cost structure but hurts BYD-linked competitors more, so it's a relative positive.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Investors are paying about 158x next year's earnings — meaning \$158 for every \$1 of profit Tesla is expected to make. For context, Toyota trades at ~10x and even Nvidia trades around 30x. That premium ONLY makes sense if you believe robotaxis and Optimus (the humanoid robot) become real businesses within 3-5 years — if Tesla is just a car company, this stock is worth maybe \$150. You're not buying earnings here, you're buying a call option on Elon executing on AI.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

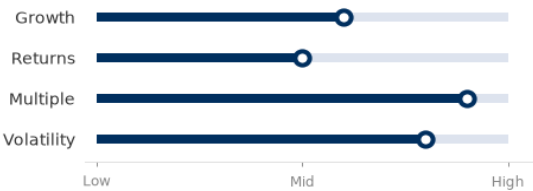
AI-Generated Pre-Market Brief | 2026-08-18 13:22 UTC

This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$339.30
12M Price Target	\$375.00
Upside / (Downside)	+10.5%
Market Cap	\$1.34T
FY2026E Revenue	\$112M
FY2027E Revenue	\$138M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.15
FY2027E EPS	\$3.10
Fwd P/E	158.0x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$375.00	\$345.00	\$310.00
6 Months	\$450.00	\$360.00	\$280.00
1 Year	\$500.00	\$375.00	\$250.00
2 Years	\$600.00	\$400.00	\$220.00
5 Years	\$800.00	\$500.00	\$200.00
10 Years	\$1200.00	\$650.00	\$150.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Autonomous vehicles and industrial AI — the loosening federal AV framework is a direct tailwind, and freight/logistics electrification (see Einride) is finally getting real orders.

COOLING OFF: Pure-play EVs without an AI story — Rivian, Lucid, and legacy auto EV divisions are struggling because the tax credit rollback hit them without the offsetting AI narrative Tesla has.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from "EV as clean energy play" to "EV as AI/robotics platform" — which is why Tesla holds up while pure EV names bleed. The narrative shift is the whole game.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the Semi story, watch the charging infrastructure names and lithium suppliers — a Semi ramp means a lot more megawatt charging capacity gets built. Also, NVDA is a second-order beneficiary since Tesla's Dojo strategy still leans on their chips.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- EINRIDE-linked names: Swedish autonomous freight is getting real capital because AV trucking regs are loosening faster than passenger AVs.
- GOOGL (Waymo): The other credible robotaxi player, quietly expanding while Tesla makes headlines — some investors prefer the "proven" AV story.

TSLA CONTEXT: TSLA is lagging its own potential — at 21% of the 52-week range, it's underperforming the AI narrative it's supposed to embody. That tells me either the market is skeptical Cybercab actually launches on time, OR there's a coiled spring here if execution surprises to the upside. I lean toward the latter given the options positioning.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

6/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 6/10 — Cautiously constructive. The Cybercab catalyst is real and near-term, but the valuation gives you almost no margin for error.

POSITION SIZE: 2-4% of portfolio. This is a high-volatility name where you want exposure to the AI upside but not enough that a bad week ruins your year.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$310-320 — that's near the low end of the recent range and gives you better risk/reward into the Cybercab launch.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months. The catalyst path: Cybercab Austin (weeks), Semi ramp evidence (Q4), Optimus updates (2027), federal AV framework (fall).

WHEN TO BAIL: If Cybercab has a serious safety incident, or Q3 auto gross margins print below 15%, or Musk announces another major distraction (new company, political role) — any of those and I'm trimming hard.

HEDGING: Simplest approach — buy some downside protection (puts) around the Cybercab launch window since the event is binary. Alternatively, pair a TSLA long with a short in a struggling EV pure-play to isolate the AI thesis.

NVIDIA Corporation

NVDA NASDAQ

Buy	\$225.01 ▼ 0.07%	12M Price Target \$260.00	52-Week Range \$164.07 – \$236.54	Market Cap \$5.45T
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NVDA: Consolidating Near Highs as AI Capex Debate Heats Up

WHAT HAPPENED

- NVDA is basically flat (\$225, -0.07%) but sitting at 84% of its 52-week range — the stock is coiled near highs, digesting gains rather than breaking out. The interesting overnight item is the WSJ report that \$3T in AI spending commitments are being kept off balance sheets. That's a double-edged sword: it confirms the AI capex tsunami is real (bullish for NVDA orders), but it also raises the "is this a bubble?" question that could hit sentiment fast.
- Options flow is loudly bullish — put/call ratio of 0.49 (way more calls than puts being bought) plus a huge unusual call sweep at the \$212.50 strike. Translation: smart money is positioning for upside, not hedging for a crash.

WHY IT MATTERS

That WSJ piece about \$3T in off-balance-sheet AI commitments is the story to watch. If regulators or accounting standards bodies force hyperscalers (Microsoft, Meta, Google, Oracle) to put those obligations on their books, their reported earnings take a hit and Wall Street could pressure them to slow spending — that's the single biggest risk to NVDA's order book. On the flip side, the fact that spending is this aggressive tells you the AI arms race isn't slowing, and NVDA still owns ~90% of the training chip market. The stock trading at 84% of its 52-week range with bullish options flow suggests the market thinks the next catalyst (likely earnings late August) breaks it higher, not lower.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

Two things matter right now: (1) The Trump administration's AI Action Plan continues to lean pro-US-chip-dominance, and the recent deal allowing NVDA to sell H20 chips back into China (in exchange for a 15% revenue share to the US government) is unusual but net-positive — it reopens billions in China revenue that was zeroed out. (2) Watch for any Congressional pushback on that revenue-share arrangement; some hawks are calling it a bad precedent. Also on the radar: the CHIPS Act 2.0 discussions and potential expanded export controls on Blackwell-class chips — if controls tighten, China revenue evaporates again.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

At ~\$5.45T market cap and roughly 38x forward earnings, you're paying \$38 for every \$1 of profit NVDA is expected to make next year — expensive by S&P standards (which trades around 22x) but actually reasonable for a company growing revenue 50%+ with 75% gross margins. The key question isn't "is it expensive?" — it's "does the AI capex cycle last 3 more years or 8?" If it's 8, this stock is cheap. If hyperscaler spending peaks in 2026, the multiple compresses fast.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

Langston's | Equity Research Coverage

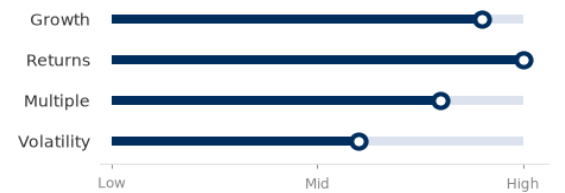
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Key Data

Price (USD)	\$225.01
12M Price Target	\$260.00
Upside / (Downside)	+15.6%
Market Cap	\$5.45T
FY2027E Revenue	\$235M
FY2028E Revenue	\$295M
FY2027E EPS	\$5.85
FY2028E EPS	\$7.40
Fwd P/E	38.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$240.00	\$228.00	\$210.00
6 Months	\$270.00	\$245.00	\$195.00
1 Year	\$300.00	\$260.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$380.00	\$310.00	\$170.00
5 Years	\$550.00	\$400.00	\$150.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$600.00	\$120.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: AI infrastructure (chips, data centers, power/utilities feeding data centers), defense tech (drone and autonomy budgets expanding), and nuclear/energy names tied to data center power demand.

COOLING OFF: Traditional enterprise software that hasn't figured out its AI story, and consumer discretionary as tariffs bite margins.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from "AI beneficiaries you have to squint to see" back to the picks-and-shovels core (NVDA, AVGO, and power infrastructure). The Anthropic funding news and continued SpaceX/xAI capital raises reinforce that private AI money is still flooding in — that liquidity eventually becomes NVDA orders.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the NVDA thesis, look at the power side — Vistra (VST), Constellation (CEG), and GE Vernova (GEV). Data centers can't run without electricity, and that's the actual bottleneck now, not chips.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): Winning on custom AI silicon deals with hyperscalers — the "other" AI chip trade that keeps pushing higher.
- ORCL (Oracle): Massive cloud infrastructure backlog announcements have re-rated the stock; they're a huge NVDA customer.

NVDA CONTEXT: NVDA is holding near highs but not leading the tape day-to-day — that's actually healthy. Sideways consolidation at 84% of range after a monster run means the stock is building a base, not topping. If it were lagging AVGO and ORCL by 10%+ that would concern me; a few points of underperformance in a consolidation window is normal.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 8/10 — I'm confident in the direction but not pounding the table because the stock is up huge and near-term earnings are binary.

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — this is a core holding, not a lottery ticket, but sizing bigger than that concentrates too much on one AI capex outcome.

ENTRY POINTS: I'd add on pullbacks to \$215-220 (recent support) and get more aggressive if we see \$200 on a broad market flush.

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months, with the near-term catalyst being August earnings and hyperscaler capex commentary through Q3.

WHEN TO BAIL: If any two of the top-4 hyperscalers cut capex guidance by 15%+, or if Blackwell has a material yield/supply problem that pushes out revenue recognition by more than a quarter.

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is buying a put option struck around \$210 expiring in 2-3 months — think of it as paying a small insurance premium so that if the stock drops 15%, that insurance pays out and offsets your losses. Costs maybe 2-3% of your position value.

Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy

\$344.00 ▼ 0.55%

12M Price Target
\$385.00

52-Week Range
\$196.60 – \$408.61

Market Cap
\$4.21T

GOOGL: Steady Near Highs, But Ackman Exit Raises Eyebrows

WHAT HAPPENED

- GOOGL is basically flat around \$344 — sitting at 70% of its 52-week range, which means the stock has had a monster run (low was \$196) and is now digesting. The overnight story is Bill Ackman dumping his Alphabet stake and rotating into another tech name. That's noise, not signal — one billionaire's rebalancing doesn't change the fundamentals — but it explains the mild weakness today.
- Bigger picture: 13F filings (the quarterly reports where big funds disclose what they own) show Wall Street broadly still loves GOOGL. So we have a "smart money is split" moment — most are buying, Ackman is selling.

WHY IT MATTERS

The unusual put buying at \$390–\$400 strikes is interesting — those are WAY out of the money (stock is \$344), which usually means someone's either hedging a big long position or betting the stock DOESN'T break out to new highs by August expiry. Combined with insider selling from Sergey Brin (though those "OTHER" transactions at \$0 are typically gifts/trusts, not open-market sales — don't panic), the near-term setup suggests the stock is capped around \$360-370 without a fresh catalyst. The real inference here: GOOGL has already priced in "AI winner" status, so from here you need EARNINGS BEATS and REGULATORY WINS to push higher, not just narrative. The bigger picture is that Alphabet is transitioning from "cheap AI play" to "fairly valued AI incumbent" — which is fine, but means gains get harder from here.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

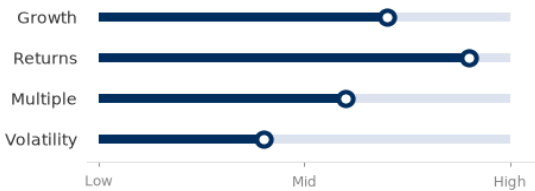
The single biggest policy variable is the DOJ antitrust remedy phase — the court already ruled Google's search monopoly illegal, and the remedy (announced fall 2025, still being appealed) has been less draconian than feared (no forced Chrome sale, but data-sharing requirements with competitors). If the appeal drags into 2027, that's actually bullish because uncertainty gets pushed out. On the tailwind side, the administration's push for domestic AI infrastructure and federal cloud modernization contracts directly benefits Google Cloud — watch for any executive order on federal AI procurement, which would be a direct catalyst. Also worth watching: EU Digital Markets Act enforcement actions, which could ding ad revenue by a few percent if they force more concessions on search defaults.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$344.00
12M Price Target	\$385.00
Upside / (Downside)	+11.9%
Market Cap	\$4.21T
FY2026E Revenue	\$415M
FY2027E Revenue	\$468M
FY2026E EPS	\$9.85
FY2027E EPS	\$11.40
Fwd P/E	24.5x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$360.00	\$348.00	\$325.00
6 Months	\$400.00	\$370.00	\$310.00
1 Year	\$430.00	\$385.00	\$290.00
2 Years	\$500.00	\$425.00	\$275.00
5 Years	\$650.00	\$520.00	\$260.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$700.00	\$300.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: AI infrastructure (hyperscalers, data center REITs, power/utilities feeding data centers) — the government spending on federal AI is a slow-burn tailwind, and enterprise AI budgets keep expanding

COOLING OFF: Pure-play generative AI startups without a distribution moat — the "everyone's an AI company" trade is fading as investors demand real revenue

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from expensive AI narrative stocks (Palantir-type multiples) INTO reasonably-valued mega-cap incumbents like GOOGL and MSFT — that's a tailwind for Alphabet specifically

RELATED PLAY: If you like the AI infrastructure buildout thesis, look at the picks-and-shovels names — data center REITs (EQIX, DLR) and power infrastructure (VST, CEG) benefit whether GOOGL or MSFT wins the AI race

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Cloud/AI integration with OpenAI keeps winning enterprise dollars, and no antitrust cloud hanging over them
- META (Meta Platforms): Ad revenue re-acceleration + Reels monetization + lower CapEx intensity than GOOGL

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL has been LAGGING MSFT and META over the past year on a total-return basis because of the antitrust discount, but that gap is closing as remedy fears fade. If Alphabet's Q3 print shows Cloud reaccelerating, that valuation gap could close fast — that's the setup to watch.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

7/10 Conviction Score

CONVICTION: 7/10 — I like the risk/reward here but the easy money (from \$196 to \$344) has been made; from here you're betting on execution, not re-rating

POSITION SIZE: 4-6% of portfolio — big enough to matter, small enough that a bad DOJ headline doesn't ruin your year

ENTRY POINTS: I'd wait for a pullback to \$330-338 (a 2-4% dip on macro noise) rather than chasing at \$344; the stock trades in tight ranges and pullbacks come every few weeks

TIME HORIZON: 12-24 months — the catalyst is Cloud margin expansion and antitrust resolution clarity

WHEN TO BAIL: Adverse structural remedy (forced divestiture), Cloud growth dropping below 20% year-over-year, or CapEx exceeding \$90B without corresponding revenue acceleration

HEDGING: Simplest hedge is just keeping position size modest; if you want protection, buying puts 5-10% out of the money for 3 months out costs about 1-2% of your position but protects against DOJ/earnings shock

Marvell Technology, Inc.

MRVL NASDAQ

Buy	\$234.33 ▲ 5.54%	12M Price Target \$275.00	52-Week Range \$61.44 – \$329.88	Market Cap \$210.32B
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MRVL: UBS Sees Billions in AI Revenue, Stock Breaks Out

WHAT HAPPENED

- MRVL popped 5.5% to \$234 — UBS put out a note saying Marvell's custom AI silicon business (chips designed specifically for Amazon, Microsoft, and Google's data centers) could generate "billions" more in revenue than the Street is modeling. When a top-tier bank raises the ceiling on a stock's AI opportunity, momentum funds pile in fast — that's what you're seeing today.
- Options flow is screaming bullish: 97,922 calls vs 36,728 puts (put/call ratio of 0.38, well below 1.0 which would be neutral). Traders are betting big on more upside — the unusual call activity at \$242.50 strike expiring this month tells me smart money thinks this run has legs into next week.

WHY IT MATTERS

The bigger picture here: Marvell is quietly becoming the "second source" for AI chips as hyperscalers (Amazon, Microsoft, Google) try to reduce their dependence on NVIDIA. Every dollar of capex those companies redirect toward custom silicon flows to Marvell, and with the CHIPS Act still funneling federal subsidies into US-based semiconductor design and manufacturing, MRVL is sitting on both a private-sector AI wave AND a government-backed industrial policy tailwind. The stock is 64% up its 52-week range but the UBS upgrade suggests the earnings power isn't fully priced in yet — analysts are still catching up to what management already telegraphed on the last earnings call. Watch for other analysts to follow UBS's lead in the next 2-3 weeks; that's typically when the "analyst piling on" phase drives the next leg up.

POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

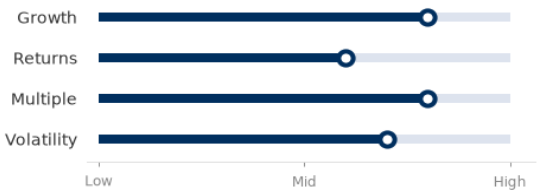
The key policy backdrop is the ongoing implementation of the CHIPS and Science Act — Marvell benefits both directly (via R&D tax credits for US-based chip design) and indirectly (their foundry partner TSMC's Arizona fab is coming online). The wildcard is US-China export controls: the Trump administration has been tightening rules on advanced chip sales to China, and Marvell historically gets ~15-20% of revenue from China. If new export restrictions land on custom AI accelerators (which is being debated in Commerce right now), that's a real headwind. Conversely, any Taiwan-China tension escalation would spike Marvell higher as investors flee to US-designed alternatives.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data

Price (USD)	\$234.33
12M Price Target	\$275.00
Upside / (Downside)	+17.4%
Market Cap	\$210.32B
FY2026E Revenue	\$8,200M
FY2027E Revenue	\$10,500M
FY2026E EPS	\$2.85
FY2027E EPS	\$4.10
Fwd P/E	82.2x

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P 500



MRVL — Marvell Technology, Inc. | August 18, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	\$260.00	\$245.00	\$215.00
6 Months	\$300.00	\$270.00	\$200.00
1 Year	\$340.00	\$275.00	\$180.00
2 Years	\$425.00	\$320.00	\$165.00
5 Years	\$600.00	\$425.00	\$140.00
10 Years	\$900.00	\$550.00	\$120.00

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Semiconductors broadly, especially custom silicon and AI infrastructure names — Barron's is literally calling this a "new bull run" in chips. Policy tailwind from CHIPS Act implementation and hyperscaler capex guidance keeps getting revised higher.

COOLING OFF: Memory chips (Micron, Western Digital) are lagging the AI logic names — commodity pricing pressure and less direct AI leverage. Consumer discretionary is quiet as rate cut expectations get pushed out.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is rotating from mega-cap "Magnificent 7" AI plays into second-derivative AI names like Marvell, FormFactor, and Applied Materials. The trade is: NVIDIA is already priced for perfection, so find the picks-and-shovels names that haven't fully re-rated yet.

RELATED PLAY: If you like MRVL's setup, look at Astera Labs (ALAB) for AI connectivity chips or Credo Technology (CRDO) for high-speed interconnect — both benefit from the same hyperscaler capex wave with less mega-cap concentration risk.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- AVGO (Broadcom): The blueprint for what Marvell is becoming — custom AI silicon for Google's TPU program has driven massive re-rating. Investors are asking "who's the next Broadcom?" and Marvell is the answer.
- AMAT (Applied Materials): Semi equipment names ride the same CHIPS Act wave — every new fab announcement means more orders.

MRVL CONTEXT: MRVL is now leading the semi rally per Barron's, which is a change from earlier this year when it was lagging. When a stock transitions from laggard to leader, it usually means institutional buyers are repositioning — that's typically a 2-3 month tailwind, not a one-day move.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 3-5% of portfolio

Entry Points: \$215-225 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Loss of Amazon Trainium or Microsoft custom silicon contract, or >15% revenue miss

Hedging: Buy protective puts or pair with a short on a richer-multiple AI name like AVGO

The following stocks were identified by screening a curated universe against the current watchlist's investment themes, today's macro environment, and smart-money signals. Scores reflect theme alignment, momentum, valuation, and institutional flow. These are research leads — not investment advice.

1	SMCI	Super Micro Computer, Inc. Semiconductors	6.9/10	BUY
Price: \$38.28 · 1M: +nan% · P/S: 0.6x · Cap: \$24.8B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
2	BAH	Booz Allen Hamilton Holding Corp. Defense Technology	6.9/10	BUY
Price: \$74.97 · 1M: +nan% · P/S: 0.8x · Cap: \$9.0B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
3	PATH	UiPath, Inc. AI & Machine Learning	6.6/10	WATCH
Price: \$15.99 · 1M: +nan% · P/S: 5.0x · Cap: \$8.3B				
■ Monitor for pullback to \$11 entry				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
4	KTOS	Kratos Defense & Security Solutions Defense Technology	6.6/10	BUY
Price: \$63.29 · 1M: +nan% · P/S: 7.8x · Cap: \$11.9B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:BULL	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	
5	AVAV	AeroVironment, Inc. Defense Technology	6.2/10	BUY
Price: \$181.13 · 1M: +nan% · P/S: 4.7x · Cap: \$9.2B				
■ Add to watchlist via tickers.txt				
			OPT:NEUT	INS:NEUT
			INST:BULL	